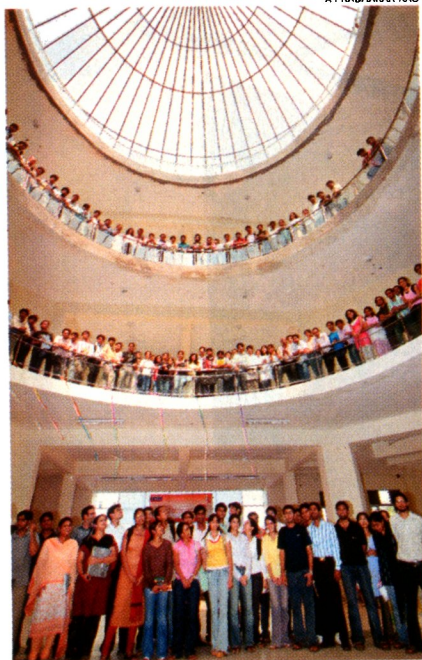


A PRABHAKAR RAO



IIT, DELHI

And you thought IIT was only about engineering. Among the biggest movers and shakers in the BT-AC Nielsen Best B-school survey, IIT-Delhi offers a unique initiative under the Department of Management Studies (DMS), which is exclusively meant for "business studies in an engineering environment". The department provides a managerial extension to the engineering studies it offers.

There is a reason to this. A degree in management is almost a logical progression for any IIT graduate. R.K. Baisya, former head of DMS, says the courses which can be taken up part-time (three years) or full-term (two years) provide a unique focus on technology management and

management systems as well as a doctoral programme in business.

DMS also provides domain specialisation in marketing, strategy, organisation management, manufacturing management, IT management and international business. The courses offered are practical rather than theory-based, with a number of exchange programmes and tie-ups with foreign institutes. IIT-Delhi has also established its mettle in the field of research. Teaching methodologies include case studies, simulation exercises and industry-oriented projects.

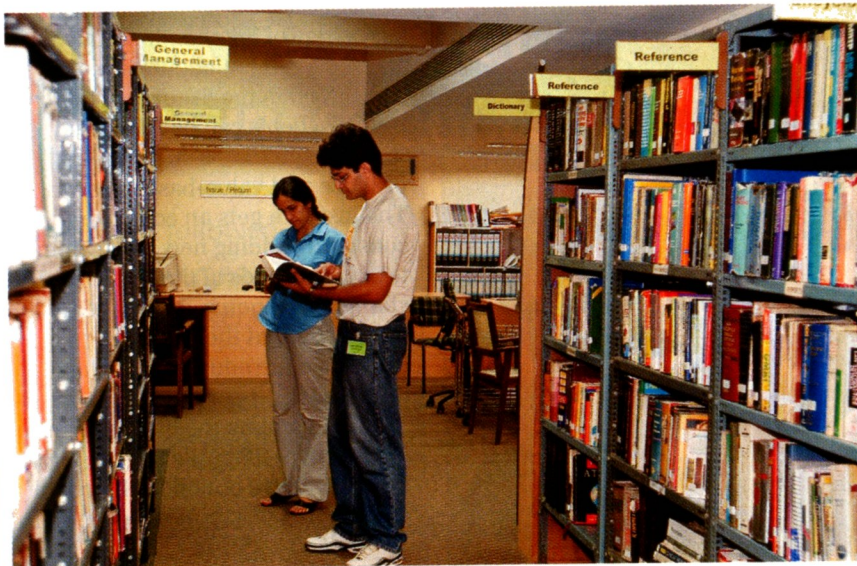
With the average fees around Rs 36,000 per semester, and companies like McKinsey, Infosys and Wipro coming down to shop for talent, IIT-Delhi is every management student's dream come true.

ICFAI, HYDERABAD

In terms of sheer numbers, the ICFAI Business School (IBS) at Hyderabad is the one that cannot be ignored. With an intake of 850 students in its postgraduate management programme and a full-time faculty of over 110, it is probably the largest business school in the country. Add to that the fact that the institute offers more than 100 electives across 11 specialisations. However, this isn't a case of quantity over quality, since the institute has made a leap from rank 13 last year to rank nine now.

"One factor that puts us ahead of other institutes is our use of case studies," says Director D.S. Rao. Unlike in an average B-school, all courses are extensively taught using case studies to bring managerial situations to classrooms. IBS Hyderabad is the world's third largest developer of management case studies, which are used by students from other B-schools too.

The institute, established in 1995, is also one of the youngest to make a mark in management education. With 30 research journals and the ICFAI Institute for Management Teachers for pedagogical training, it does stand out from the rest.



WELINGKAR, MUMBAI

An organisation differentiates itself from the others not by doing different things, but by doing things differently. Welingkar Institute of Management has adopted this approach very efficiently, which is evident from the jump in its ranking this year.

Says Director Uday Salunkhe, "Last year we achieved some major milestones. The most important realisation was that the soul of a world-class management institute lies in the strength of its academics, industry interface, global

exposure and the attitude of its students and the faculty."

Another differentiating factor for the institute is its attempt to enroll students who may not fit the "prospective MBA profile" or who may have given up their pursuit of education due to socio-economic reasons.

Keen on building strong infrastructure, Welingkar has introduced videoconferencing for its students. It has also introduced several career-oriented subjects like project management, consulting skills and shopper's psychology.

SOURIK KAR